



Executive Director

Expected Hours: 40 hours/week (full-time)

Location: Remote/Gombe, Nigeria¹ (hybrid role with >3 months/year on-site)

Reports to: Board of Directors

About Taimaka

[Taimaka](#) works to end childhood deaths from acute malnutrition in northern Nigeria by delivering a pediatric malnutrition program that is 63% cheaper than legacy approaches. So far, we've used our model to treat 16,000+ children across Northeastern Nigeria. Our track record has led charity evaluators like [Founders Pledge](#) and [GiveWell](#) to identify us as one of the most cost-effective nonprofits in global health.

Our goal is to save as many lives as possible per dollar spent. We take this mandate seriously. Taimaka was founded in 2019 to work on agriculture and food security. We built a large microfinance program that was stable but not sufficiently cost-effective, so we pivoted to malnutrition treatment in 2022.

Over the past three years, Taimaka has grown its malnutrition treatment program from a small pilot to a more than 400-person organization delivering malnutrition treatment to over 10,000 children annually. We recently received major support from GiveWell and other evidence-focused funders to scale our impact and continue refining our model. (Read about our GiveWell grant [here](#).)

Our goal for the next five years is to 10x our annual impact by scaling our program to reach 100,000 children annually, which will likely involve expanding to new countries. We are seeking an Executive Director to scale our proven approach while strengthening the systems, culture, and leadership needed to deliver this cost-effective intervention at scale.

¹ Please note that Gombe is subject to a 'do not travel' advisory from the U.S. Department of State. Expatriate staff from Taimaka have lived and worked in the state for a number of years without issue, and we have extensive local support networks in place to keep staff safe. However, accepting this role does mean accepting an elevated level of risk.

About the Job

The Executive Director will steward the organization's cost-effectiveness mission, oversee day-to-day operations, and ensure strong alignment across Taimaka's operations, research, program, and fundraising teams.

In the first six months, the Executive Director will:

- Lead the development of a 5-year strategic plan to scale the malnutrition program from 10,000 children to 100,000 children without compromising cost-effectiveness
- Join staff on-site in Gombe State, Nigeria, for at least three months to deepen their understanding of the program and their relationships with staff and partners
- Establish clear organizational goals, decision-making structures, and performance management systems to support Taimaka's growth
- Oversee the delivery of commitments under Taimaka's current GiveWell grant

Key Responsibilities

1. Lead with Strategy and Purpose

- Lead Taimaka's mission to make malnutrition treatment better and cheaper, ensuring every major decision advances cost-effectiveness and the number of lives saved
- Translate GiveWell funding requirements into clear annual goals, budgets, and measurable outcomes to ensure renewal

2. Strengthen Funding and Partnerships

- Maintain strong relationships with GiveWell, Founders Pledge, and other evidence-focused funders; ensure transparency and timely reporting
- Represent Taimaka publicly and cultivate new funding partnerships
- Drive Taimaka's overall fundraising agenda, in conjunction with dedicated fundraising staff
- Communicate impact with evidence-based narratives that highlight the cost-effectiveness and excellence of Taimaka's CMAM program

3. Oversee Program Delivery and Applied Research

- Work with our programs staff to ensure high-quality implementation of community-based malnutrition treatment
- Become a subject matter expert in malnutrition treatment, assist with program planning, and help develop new techniques and approaches to ensure our model continues to work as Taimaka grows
- Support the design and testing of innovations (e.g., new monitoring or delivery methods) that improve cost-effectiveness and scalability

4. Develop People and Culture

- Develop Taimaka beyond a startup: clarify roles, decision-making structures, and lines of authority; delegate effectively to empower mid-level and junior leaders to execute program operations
- Lead with empathy and strong conflict-resolution skills; surface disagreements early, navigate different cultures and viewpoints, and mediate across perspectives

What We're Looking For

We're seeking a strategic leader who's excited to guide Taimaka in scaling our impact without compromising cost-effectiveness and cares deeply about the same values that guide Taimaka today. Below, we outline what we're looking for through core and bonus attributes, along with a descriptive sketch of the kind of person we think would excel in this role.

Core Attributes (Required):

- **Commitment to ambitious, cost-effective, evidence-based impact.** We're looking for candidates who are deeply aligned with our core values, are focused on ensuring our work is evidence-based, and are committed to maximizing the impact we have per dollar.
 - Successful candidates will likely be members of the Effective Altruism community or otherwise convinced of the intrinsic value of GiveWell-style cost-effectiveness analyses as a tool to maximize impact.
- **Strategic leadership.** Experience managing a fast-growing organization, ideally with multi-million-dollar budgets, >100 staff, and a number of international team members.
- **Fundraising and stakeholder management.** Confident working with major donors, boards, and institutional funders; transparent and credible communicator. Someone who thinks about the counterfactual value of funding and whether beneficiaries are best served if funds go elsewhere.
- **Evidence-driven mindset.** Default to using data and operational metrics to guide decisions.
- **People and culture leadership.** Skilled at motivating teams, resolving conflict, and building trust across diverse perspectives and geographies.
- **Field presence.** Able to work effectively with Nigerian and international staff and committed to spending significant time on-site in Gombe State (or through a hybrid arrangement with shorter but more frequent travel).
- **Be hands-on.** We want an Executive Director who will become a subject-matter expert in acute malnutrition and provide meaningful guidance and oversight for our programming.

Bonus Attributes (Preferred):

- Experience scaling a direct-delivery global health intervention that prioritizes cost-effectiveness
- Background in CMAM, nutrition, or primary health systems
- Experience managing founder transitions or leadership succession in international teams
- Experience partnering with governmental health systems in low- or middle-income countries
- Experience working in low-resource settings

About You:

Below is a quick sketch of the kind of person who we expect to excel in this position. It is not exhaustive, and we don't expect you to be exactly like this description. Don't let it stop you from applying if you're not a perfect fit! In general, we think a good Executive Director:

- Is deeply results-focused and motivated by creating the most impact possible
- Has high standards and a constant desire to improve
- Is even-keeled and unlikely to be thrown by new challenges
- Is highly collaborative, with a low personal ego

- Is flexible and excited to switch between big picture and hands-on work as needed
- Is comfortable making tough decisions (like shutting down programs, rejecting more funding, terminations) when it's the most impactful thing to do
- Cares about transparency and is strongly truth-seeking
- Has a bias to action
- Is willing to buck orthodoxy when it is not supported by evidence
- Is informed about key [effective altruist](#) principles and concepts